

After rebuke, Trump insults justices

He calls the court majority ‘fools,’ ‘lapdogs’ and ‘disgrace to our nation.’

By Ana Ceballos and Gavin J. Quinton

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Friday lashed out at Supreme Court justices who struck down a key part of his tariffs agenda, calling them “fools” who made a “terrible, defective decision” that he plans to circumvent by imposing new levies in a different way.

In a defiant appearance at the White House, Trump told reporters that his administration will impose new tariffs by using alternative legal means. He cast the ruling as a technical, not permanent, setback for his trade policy, insisting that the “end result is going to get us more money.”

The president late Friday signed an executive order imposing a new 10% tariff, citing a 1974 law. Under that law, the tariffs can last for only 150 days. An extension would require congressional approval.

Asked by a reporter whether he planned to issue the 10% global tariffs for 150 days or indefinitely, Trump said: “We have a right to do pretty much what we want to do.”

The sharp response underscores how central tariffs have been to Trump’s economic and political identity. He portrayed the ruling as another example of institutional resistance to his “America First” agenda and pledged to continue fighting to hold on to his trade authority despite the ruling from the nation’s highest court.

Trump said the ruling was “deeply disappointing” and called the justices who voted against his policy — including Justices Neil M. Gorsuch and Amy Coney Barrett, whom he nominated to the court — “fools,” “lapdogs” and a “disgrace to our nation.”

“I am ashamed of certain members of the court,” Trump told reporters. “Absolutely ashamed for not having the courage to do what’s right for our country.”

In a social media post, the president wrote that he believed the court opinion has been “swayed by Foreign Interests and a Political [See **Rebuke**, A7]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

TRAFFIC at the Port of Los Angeles, top, has declined recently. The suspension of tariffs may bring some relief to small businesses such as Baller Hardware, above.

Outdoors-loving friends among avalanche victims

The women on a backcountry ski trip were mothers, adventurers and sisters

By Grace Toohey and Salvador Hernandez

Most of the victims of California’s deadliest avalanche in modern history were part of a tight-knit circle of moms who lived across Northern California and in Idaho and loved to be together in the mountains.

Six of the nine people who died in the avalanche north of Lake Tahoe on Tuesday were part of that group of close friends who had together planned the backcountry ski trip. The other three victims were hired guides who led the expedition.

The families of the women said in a statement that they were “devastated beyond words.”

“Our focus right now is supporting our children through this incredible tragedy and honoring the lives of these extraordinary women,” the statement said. “They were all mothers, wives and friends, all of whom connected through the love of the outdoors.”

Officials have located the remains of eight of the victims. The ninth individual remains unaccounted for but is presumed dead, according to authorities. Six

people were rescued from where the group encountered the avalanche in the Castle Peak area.

Although the families have identified some of the deceased, officials have not yet released the names of those killed, and extreme weather in the area has continued to stymie efforts to retrieve their bodies.

But as information has slowly revealed more about the ski trip and those who died in the avalanche, grief has shaken communities across the region.

“We are heartbroken and are doing our best to care for one another and our families in the way we know these women would have wanted,” the families said in the statement, which also requested privacy for their loved ones.

Gov. Gavin Newsom on Thursday told the media that his wife learned family friends were among the victims.

“It’s tragic,” Newsom said. “Our hearts go out to those that lost their lives and a community of skiers, a community [See **Ski trip**, A14]

Supreme Court strikes down most Trump tariffs as illegal

The justices say, 6-3, that a 1977 emergency powers law does not authorize the duties.

By David G. Savage

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court ruled Friday that President Trump’s sweeping worldwide tariffs are illegal and cannot stand without the approval of Congress.

The 6-3 decision deals Trump his most significant defeat at the Supreme Court.

Last year, the justices issued temporary orders to block several of his initiatives, but Friday’s ruling is the first to hold that the president overstepped his legal authority.

Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr., speaking for the court, said Congress, not the president, has the power to impose taxes and tariffs.

Trump slammed the decision as “deeply disappointing” and said he was “ashamed of certain members” of the court. “They are frankly a disgrace to our nation,” he told reporters.

He said he would press ahead to impose tariffs

under other laws.

“We have very powerful alternatives,” he said, adding that he would act on his own and would not consult Congress. “I have the right to decide.”

However, the Supreme Court majority focused on the Constitution’s separation of powers.

Roberts said Trump wrongly claimed support for his go-it-alone approach under a 1977 law, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act, which refers to an “unusual and extraordinary threat” to America’s national security but does not mention tariffs or taxes.

“The President asserts the extraordinary power to unilaterally impose tariffs of unlimited amount, duration, and scope. In light of the breadth, history, and constitutional context of that asserted authority, he must identify clear congressional authorization to exercise it,” he wrote in *Learning Resources vs. Trump*.

“Until now no President has read the International Emergency Economic Powers Act to confer such power. We claim no special competence in matters of economics or foreign affairs. We claim only, as we must, the [See **Court**, A6]

What high court ruling means for L.A.’s economy

By Laurence Darmiento

The Supreme Court’s decision Friday to strike down the majority of tariffs imposed by President Trump could provide some relief to L.A.’s trade-reliant economy — but only if they are not reimposed again through other means.

The court’s 6-3 ruling that Trump didn’t have the authority to impose tariffs under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act rolled back levies that have upended international trade.

“We’ve seen that the tariffs have a significant impact on our supply chain, on our manufacturers and especially on our port logistics and trade sector,” said Stephen Cheung, chief exe-

cutive of the nonprofit Los Angeles County Economic Development Corp.

“I think this decision will have a significant impact on the Los Angeles economy. However, it’s going to take a long time to unravel, so we’ll see specifically how everything is going to pan out,” he said.

The tariffs dealt a blow to a large swath of businesses in Southern California and across the state, including farmers, automakers, home builders, tech companies and apparel retailers.

MGA Entertainment, the Chatworth maker of Bratz dolls, said a little more than half of its products are made in China, while hardware and lumber seller Anawalt in Malibu said the majority of its lumber comes from Canada and nearly all [See **Economy**, A6]

LAFD tried to shield Bass, others

By Paul Pringle and Alene Tchekmedyan

Shortly before releasing an after-action review report on the Palisades fire, the Los Angeles Fire Department issued a confidential memo detailing plans to protect Mayor Karen Bass and others from “reputational harm” in connection with the city’s handling of the catastrophic blaze, records obtained by The

Times show.

“It’s our goal to prepare and protect Mayor Bass, the City, and the LAFD from reputational harm associated with the upcoming public release of its AARR, through a comprehensive strategy that includes risk assessment, proactive and reactive communications, and crisis response,” the memo states, referring to the acronym for the LAFD’s report.

The 13-page document is

on LAFD letterhead and includes email addresses for department officials, representatives of Bass’ office and public relations consultants hired to help shape messaging about the fire, although it is not known to whom it was eventually distributed. The Times obtained the memo, titled “LAFD AARR: Strategic Response Plan,” from the LAFD through the California Public Records Act.

[See **Fire**, A14]

Iranians brace, some seek new start

By Ramin Mostaghimi and Nabih Bulos

TEHRAN — Iranians — battered by a government crackdown whose dead have yet to be fully tallied, still reeling from the 12-day conflict with Israel last year and fed up with endemic economic malaise born of sanctions and corruption — now face the prospect of another

war with emotions ranging from anger to anticipation, but above all, exhaustion.

“Again and again, this routine of anxiety and worries,” said Ali, a barber in Tehran who like most of those interviewed did not give his last name for fear of harassment.

“All this feels like a pre-written scenario that has taken this long to unfold,” Ali said. “It’s not a pleasant feel-

ing at all.”

A ticking clock hangs over Washington and Tehran’s latest diplomatic roundelay.

As the two sides continue Oman-brokered negotiations in Geneva, the U.S. has amassed the largest military force in the Middle East since the 2003 Iraq invasion.

On Friday, President Trump said he was consider- [See **Iran**, A3]

MILAN-CORTINA OLYMPICS



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

THE GOAL IS GOLD

Auston Matthews, center, attacks Slovakia’s defense in Team USA’s 6-2 semifinal victory. The U.S. will face Canada for the gold medal. **SPORTS, D6**

Caltech scientist is shot to death

Carl Grillmair is found dead on the front porch of his Antelope Valley home. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Lawmakers seek insurance probe

After Times story, they aim to help fire victims collect State Farm payouts. **BUSINESS, A10**

Weather

Mostly sunny; warmer. L.A. Basin: 72/50. **B8**

